Civitas

Infrastructure for Network States

v4.0 — February 2026

A modular platform providing composable primitives for every phase of the network state trajectory. Five integrated layers — Identity, Treasury, Governance, Census, and Federation — each activating progressively as communities mature.

Executive Summary

Every organized community — a condominium, an NGO, a cooperative, a sports club, a labor union, a board of directors, a religious congregation, a neighborhood association — faces the same challenge: members contribute resources, a small group manages them, and everyone else is blind. The members are the real owners, but they have no real-time visibility into how their money is spent, no verifiable way to ensure decisions are executed, and no mechanism to hold administrators accountable.

Civitas is a modular platform that provides composable infrastructure for community self-governance. It operates through five integrated primitives — Identity, Treasury, Governance, Census, and Federation — that activate progressively as communities mature.

Version 3 introduces two fundamental evolutions:

- **A Fintech Partnership Model** that turns Treasury into a live financial rail through a licensed IFPE (electronic payments institution), enabling native SPEI payments, automatic reconciliation, and programmatic disbursements.
- **The Integrated Primitive System** — a framework where Identity, Treasury, and Governance are not separate modules but a single interconnected machine. Collective decisions trigger automatic financial consequences. Financial standing affects governance rights. Identity status depends on both.

> *The result: when a community votes to hire a vendor, the payment executes automatically through regulated financial rails. No admin discretion. No execution gap. The decision IS the execution.*

Target Market (Mexico)	Revenue Model	Go-to-Market
930K+ condominiums 60K+ cooperatives 28K+ religious orgs 50K+ NGOs, clubs, unions	SaaS subscription + Transaction fees (0.5%) + Financial products	Residential first, then NGOs, cooperatives, clubs, and beyond

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1. Introduction

Every human community that manages shared resources — a condominium, an NGO, a cooperative, a sports club, a labor union, a professional guild, a religious congregation, a neighborhood association, a school board — faces the same fundamental challenge: how to organize collective life transparently, make decisions legitimately, and manage shared resources accountably.

We call the systematic inability to do this **governance opacity**: stakeholders contribute resources, intermediaries manage them, and no mechanism exists for continuous verification.

Balaji Srinivasan articulated a path from online community to sovereign polity [1]. This trajectory is compelling but lacks standardized infrastructure. Each community attempting it must build identity, financial, governance, and census systems from scratch.

Civitas provides that infrastructure. We define five composable primitives — Identity, Treasury, Governance, Census, and Federation — that activate progressively as a community matures. Each community defines its own rules for how these primitives interact.

What makes v3 different is not merely the addition of a fintech partner. It is the recognition that the three core primitives — Identity, Treasury, and Governance — are not independent modules but a single integrated system where **decisions have financial consequences**, **financial standing affects governance rights**, and **identity status depends on both**.

2. The Governance Opacity Problem

A residential building in Mexico City manages $36M MXN annually; residents have zero real-time visibility into spending. An NGO with 2,000 donors publishes an annual report but offers no way to verify day-to-day expenditures. A sports club board collects membership fees and makes spending decisions behind closed doors. A cooperative of 50 manufacturers makes purchasing decisions without transparent cost allocation. A labor union collects dues from 10,000 workers but only the executive committee sees the books.

The pattern is universal: **the people who own the resources are not the people who control them**. Condominium owners, NGO donors, club members, cooperative partners, union workers, congregation members — they are all stakeholders who contribute but cannot verify. A board, a council, a treasurer, an administrator stands between the members and the truth.

The trust-based model creates four distinct failure modes:

- **Information asymmetry** — administrators know more than stakeholders
- **Participation barriers** — decisions are made by whoever shows up
- **Accountability gaps** — no mechanism to verify that decisions are executed
- **The execution gap** — even when a community successfully votes, there is no mechanism to ensure the decision is carried out. An assembly votes to hire a new security company; the admin hires a different one. A vote passes to allocate $500K to reserves; nothing forces the transfer. The gap between decision and execution is where corruption lives.

> *Civitas closes this gap. When a vote passes, the money moves. Automatically. Through regulated financial rails. No admin discretion. No execution gap. The decision IS the execution.*

3. The Integrated Primitive System

Previous versions presented Identity, Treasury, and Governance as three separate primitives that happen to coexist. Version 3 recognizes that this framing understates the real architecture. The three primitives are not neighbors — they are an interconnected machine where each one affects and is affected by the others.

> *Identity determines who can govern. Governance determines how money moves. Treasury determines who retains identity rights. The circle is the product.*

3.1 Connection 1: Governance → Treasury (Executable Decisions)

When a community votes to approve an expense, that decision triggers an automatic financial action through the fintech rail. A proposal includes not just a question ('should we hire company X?') but a financial instruction ('pay $150,000 MXN to CLABE XXXX from category Security'). When the vote passes, the instruction executes. No intermediary. No discretion.

The IFPE partner provides programmatic SPEI disbursement via API. Civitas wraps this in a governance layer: the community defines who can propose, what quorum is required, and whether automatic execution is enabled. The rules are configurable. The enforcement is structural.

3.2 Connection 2: Treasury → Identity (Financial Standing)

A member's financial standing — whether they are current on obligations — affects their identity status. Mexican condominium law already allows communities to restrict voting rights for delinquent members. Civitas makes this enforceable and automatic.

When a member falls behind on payments (tracked through the fintech rail), their identity status changes. Depending on community rules, this can mean loss of voting rights, proposal rights, or restricted access. Critically, **this works both ways**: when the member pays, rights are automatically restored. The payment itself is the restoration event.

3.3 Connection 3: Identity → Governance (Rights Engine)

A member's identity attributes determine their governance rights, enriched by financial standing feedback. The governance engine checks not just 'is this person a member?' but 'is this person a member in good standing?' before allowing actions.

Action	Identity Check	Treasury Check	Configurable?
Cast a vote	Active member	Current on payments (opt.)	Yes — community sets grace period

Action	Identity Check	Treasury Check	Configurable?
Create a proposal	Active member + role	Current on payments (opt.)	Yes — community sets who can propose
Delegate vote	Active member	Current on payments (opt.)	Yes — community enables/disables
Approve disbursement	Admin or Treasurer	N/A (role-based)	Yes — community sets thresholds
View financial data	Any active member	No restriction	No — transparency is structural

Table 1. The Rights Engine: every governance action is checked against Identity and Treasury state.

3.4 The Feedback Loop

The three connections form a closed, self-enforcing loop:

1. Member pays quota → Treasury records automatically → Identity status: good standing → Governance rights: active
2. Member votes on proposal → Proposal passes → Treasury executes payment via SPEI → All members see it in rea
3. Member stops paying → Grace period expires → Identity: suspended → Governance rights: revoked
4. Delinquent member pays arrears → Identity restores automatically → Governance rights reactivate. No admin neede

> *Pay, and you govern. Decide, and the money moves. Stop paying, and you lose your voice. Resume paying, and you get it back. No admin makes these decisions. The rules do.*

4. The Five Primitives

4.1 Identity — Who are we?

Identity answers: who belongs, what rights they have, and how membership is verified. In a condominium, identity links to property ownership. In an NGO, to donor or beneficiary status. In a cooperative, to a membership share. In a sports club, to an active membership. In a labor union, to employment verification. The Identity primitive is configurable and portable across all these verticals.

v3 enrichment: Identity is no longer a static registry but a dynamic status reflecting a member's relationship with other primitives. A member's record includes static attributes (name, unit, ownership %), role (admin, treasurer, member), and computed status (financial standing, voting eligibility, participation history) derived in real time.

4.2 Treasury — What do we have?

Treasury answers: what resources exist, how they are spent, and whether every member can verify it in real time. Every transaction is categorized, timestamped, and attributable.

v3 evolution: Treasury operates in progressive modes. **Import mode** (MVP): data ingested from external systems. **Fintech Rail mode** (Phase 2+): money flows natively through regulated SPEI rails. Each community gets a CLABE. Payments are automatic. Disbursements are triggered by governance decisions. Transparency is a structural consequence of how money moves.

4.3 Governance — How do we decide?

Governance answers: who can propose, who can vote, how weight is calculated, what constitutes quorum, and — critically in v3 — what happens when a decision passes.

Proposals are not just questions. They are **executable instructions**: a financial instruction (pay X to Y), a configuration change (modify quota), a membership action (approve new member), or a combination. When the vote passes, the instruction executes automatically.

Proposal Type	When Approved...	Automatic Action
Expense approval	Vote passes with required majority	SPEI disbursement to vendor via IFPE
Budget allocation	Vote passes	Budget line created/modified in Treasury
Vendor selection	Vote selects option A, B, or C	Contract + first payment to selected vendor
Quota modification	Vote passes (qualified majority)	New payment obligations for all members
Emergency fund	Vote passes (super-majority)	Transfer from reserve to operating account
Rule change	Vote passes (qualified majority)	Community configuration updated

Proposal Type	When Approved...	Automatic Action
Member admission	Vote passes	Invitation sent, identity record created

Table 2. Executable governance: every proposal type triggers an automatic consequence.

4.4 Census — How big are we?

Census tracks member count, economic activity, and geographic footprint. With the fintech rail, Census reports verified economic activity — actual money flowing through the community, not self-reported estimates. This is critical for federation and for demonstrating scale to external institutions.

4.5 Federation — How do we connect?

Federation enables communities to recognize each other's members, coordinate joint decisions, and share resources. With the fintech rail, federated treasuries can execute joint purchases: 100 condominiums vote to switch energy provider, 50 NGOs coordinate a joint fundraising campaign, or a network of cooperatives negotiates bulk pricing — and the collective payment disburses from a federated account.

5. The Fintech Partnership

Civitas is a governance platform, not a financial institution. The financial infrastructure is provided by a licensed IFPE (Institución de Fondos de Pago Electrónico) under Mexican fintech law (Ley Fintech, 2018).

5.1 Division of Responsibilities

Function	Civitas Owns	IFPE Partner Owns
Core function	Governance, identity, community mgmt	Financial license, fund custody, compliance
User interface	All UI/UX, mobile app, dashboards	None (white-label via API)
Payments	Instruction generation	Execution (SPEI transfer, settlement)
Accounts	Community + member records	CLABE generation, fund segregation
Compliance	Community governance rules	KYC/AML, CNBV reporting, audits
Data	Governance data, member directory	Financial tx data (shared via API)

Table 3. Clear separation: Civitas governs, IFPE moves money.

5.2 How Money Flows

Collection:

Community created → IFPE generates CLABE → Admin configures quotas → Members see payment obligations → Member pays via SPEI → IFPE receives, notifies Civitas via webhook → Treasury records payment, obligation marked paid, dashboard updates, Identity refreshes. All in real time.

Governance-triggered disbursement:

Proposal to pay vendor passes with required majority → 48-hour cool-down (configurable) → Civitas verifies sufficient balance → Sends instruction to IFPE → SPEI payment executes → Proposal status changes to 'executed' → All members see the decision AND its financial consequence in one timeline.

5.3 Treasury Modes (Progressive)

Mode	How Data Enters	Trust Level	When
Import	CSV/Excel upload	Reported (admin honesty)	MVP
Connector	API sync with ERP	Reported (system honesty)	Post-MVP
Fintech Rail	Direct SPEI via IFPE	Verified (regulated rails)	Phase 2+
Hybrid	Mix of import + rail	Mixed (verified + reported)	Transition

Table 4. Treasury modes are additive. The dashboard distinguishes verified from reported transactions.

5.4 Why Not Build the Financial Layer?

Obtaining an IFPE license requires ~$20M MXN in capital, 12–18 months of CNBV approval, and ongoing compliance infrastructure. The partnership lets Civitas go to market immediately. If scale justifies it (1,000+ communities), applying for a proprietary license becomes a strategic option — not a prerequisite.

6. The Configurable Rules Engine

Every connection in the Integrated Primitive System is configurable. Communities define their own rules for how Identity, Treasury, and Governance interact. The engine does not impose a governance model — it provides the machine. The community provides the parameters.

6.1 Configuration by Vertical

The following table shows how different community types configure the same engine with entirely different parameters. These are just examples — every parameter is fully customizable:

Parameter	Residential	NGO / Foundation	Cooperative	Club / Union
Voting weight	Ownership %	1 donor = 1 vote or tiered	1 member = 1 vote	1 member = 1 vote
Quorum	75% / 51% / config.	30% of active donors	2/3 members	50% + 1
Proposal rights	Any owner	Board + donors above tier	Any member	Board + any member
Delegation	Yes, power of attorney	Yes, to proxy	Yes, to delegate	Yes, configurable
Auto-execution	Enabled for expenses	Enabled above threshold	Enabled above $10K	Disabled (manual)
Payment-to-vote	No vote if 2+ mo. late	No vote if inactive donor	No vote if year unpaid	No vote if dues late
Payment restoration	Auto on payment	Auto on new donation	Requires board approval	Auto on payment
Disbursement approval	Admin <$50K / Vote >$50K	Board <$100K / Vote >$100K	Vote for all > $10K	Board for all
Cool-down period	48 hours	72 hours	72 hours	1 week

Table 5. Same engine, different rules. Every parameter is community-defined. Religious orgs, school associations, guilds, and other verticals configure similarly.

Every row in this table is a **cross-primitive rule**. 'No vote if 2+ months delinquent' connects Treasury (payment status) to Identity (standing) to Governance (voting rights). 'Board can spend < $100K without vote' connects Identity (role) to Treasury (amount) to Governance (approval threshold). The engine evaluates these rules in real time at every action.

6.2 The Social Smart Contract

Srinivasan describes the network state as governed by a 'social smart contract' — explicit, visible rules that constrain governing authority [1]. The Civitas Rules Engine IS the social smart contract. It is not code on a blockchain — it is a configurable rule set stored in the community's configuration, visible to all members, and enforced by the platform.

Members can see the rules. Members can propose changes (via Governance). Changes require qualified majorities. And once the rules are set, the system enforces them without admin discretion. This is **programmatic governance without requiring any member to understand programming**.

7. System Architecture

7.1 Layer Architecture

Layer	Name	Responsibility	Phase
6	Verticals	Domain-specific modules (residential, religious, mfg)	MVP+
5	Federation	Inter-community coordination, portable identity	Post-MVP
4	Census	Population metrics, verified economic activity	Post-MVP
3	Governance	Proposals, voting, quorum, delegation, executable decisions	MVP
2	Treasury	Financial dashboard, payment tracking, standing signals	MVP
1	Identity	Members, roles, dynamic status, rights engine	MVP
0	Financial Rail	IFPE API, CLABEs, SPEI, webhooks, disbursements	Phase 2
«	Ingestion	CSV/Excel import, ERP connectors, normalization	MVP

Table 6. Layer architecture. Layers 1–3 are the integrated core.

7.2 Multi-Tenant Isolation

Each community is an isolated tenant. Row-Level Security (RLS) at the database level ensures complete data sovereignty. Communities share infrastructure but never data. Different communities can have entirely different rule configurations — the engine is the same, the parameters are sovereign.

7.3 Progressive Activation

Phase	Active Layers	Integration Level
Startup Society	Identity + Treasury (import) + Governance	Basic: vote + view finances
Growing Community	All core + Financial Rail	Full: executable decisions + payment-to-vote
Network Union	All core + Census	Full + verified economic metrics
Network Archipelago	All + Federation	Full + cross-community governance
Network State	All layers fully active	Full financial + governance sovereignty

Table 7. Progressive activation. Integration deepens with each phase.

8. Market Opportunity

Civitas targets any organized community where members contribute shared resources and a smaller group administers them. The common thread is structural: the real owners (members, donors, residents, partners) are blind to how their money is managed. The addressable market in Mexico alone is substantial:

Vertical	Est. Communities	Avg. Monthly Flow	Pain Point
Residential condominiums	930,000+	$500K–$2M MXN	Zero visibility, admin fraud, no accountability
Cooperatives (mfg, agri, services)	60,000+	$1M–$10M MXN	Opaque cost allocation, no transparent decisions
NGOs and foundations	50,000+	$200K–$5M MXN	Donors can't verify spending; boards control everything
Religious congregations	28,000+	$200K–$800K MXN	No verifiable accounting, trust-only model
Sports and social clubs	25,000+	$100K–$1M MXN	Board makes all decisions; members pay but don't see
Labor unions	15,000+	$500K–$5M MXN	Dues collected centrally, zero transparency to workers
Professional guilds/chambers	15,000+	$100K–$500K MXN	Fragmented governance, manual processes
School parent associations	200,000+	$50K–$300K MXN	Parents contribute but have no visibility or voice
Neighborhood associations	100,000+	$50K–$500K MXN	Informal governance, no financial accountability

Table 8. Addressable market by vertical (Mexico). The problem is universal across all organized communities.

The critical insight is that **Civitas does not serve a vertical — it serves a pattern**. Any group where members contribute resources and a smaller body administers them has the same governance opacity problem. The configurable rules engine means each vertical is just a different parameter set on the same machine.

The initial beachhead is **residential condominiums** — the vertical with the most acute pain, the clearest regulatory framework, and the most standardized governance structure. But every community that pays, decides, and needs accountability is a Civitas community.

Beyond Mexico, the governance opacity problem is universal. Latin America, Southeast Asia, and parts of Europe share similar structures across condominiums, cooperatives, NGOs, clubs, and unions. The configurable rules engine makes geographic expansion a parameter change, not a rebuild.

9. Revenue Model

The Integrated Primitive System creates three compounding revenue streams:

1. SaaS Subscription

Communities pay for the governance platform (Identity + Governance). This is the base revenue that validates product-market fit and provides predictable recurring income.

2. Transaction Revenue

A small percentage on payments processed through the fintech rail (shared with IFPE). For a 200-unit condominium at $3,500/month per unit = $700K MXN/month in flow per community. At 0.5%, that yields $3,500/month per community — potentially exceeding the SaaS subscription.

3. Financial Products

Future opportunities: community savings accounts (reserve funds earning interest), collective insurance, bulk purchasing power, micro-lending for delinquent members. The IFPE partner enables these without Civitas needing its own license.

> *The compounding effect: 1,000 communities x $700K MXN/month = $700M MXN/month in processed volume. At 0.5%, that is $3.5M MXN/month in transaction revenue alone — recurring and growing with the network.*

10. Deployment Strategy

> *Technology adoption follows pain, not ideology. We do not sell 'network states.' We sell the ability to see where your money goes and make decisions that execute automatically.*

Phase 1: Validate — 1 building, 200 members

Identity + Treasury (import) + Governance. No fintech rail yet. Validate that transparency and digital governance have product-market fit. Integration is partial: votes pass but require manual execution. We learn what the community wants to automate before automating.

Phase 2: Integrate — 10 buildings, 2,000 members

Activate IFPE integration. Native payments. Automatic reconciliation. Turn on payment-to-vote link. Turn on executable governance. This is where the Integrated Primitive System comes alive: pay, vote, execute, verify — all in one platform.

Phase 3: Scale — 100 communities, 50,000 members

Expand to NGOs, cooperatives, clubs, unions, religious congregations, and guilds. Each vertical uses the same engine with different parameters. Financial products begin: community savings, collective insurance.

Phase 4: Federate — 1,000 communities, 500,000 members

Communities federate. Cross-community governance enables collective purchasing. Federated treasuries execute joint decisions. Census provides verifiable proof of scale.

Phase 5: Network State — 10,000+ communities, 5M+ members

Full institutional backend. Consider proprietary IFPE license. On-chain verification for cross-border. The Social Smart Contract becomes the constitutional framework.

Phase	Members	Treasury Mode	What We Sell
1. Validate	200	Import	Transparency
2. Integrate	2,000	Fintech Rail	Automated governance
3. Scale	50,000	Rail + products	Governance infrastructure
4. Federate	500,000	Multi-community	Collective power
5. Network State	5M+	Sovereign	Self-determination

Table 9. The network state is not sold. It emerges from communities that govern themselves.

11. Competitive Landscape

Existing solutions serve fragments of the problem. None integrates identity, treasury, and governance into a single machine that works across verticals — from condos to NGOs to unions:

Capability	Admin Software	DAO Tooling	Civic Tech	Civitas v3
Identity	Admin-managed	Wallet address	Voter registration	Dynamic status + standing
Treasury	Admin-only ledger	On-chain (real-time)	None	All members (real-time, verified)
Governance	None	Token-weighted	Voting only	Configurable + executable
Payment collection	Separate bank	Token transfers	None	Native SPEI (integrated)
Decision execution	Manual (admin)	Smart contract	None	Auto-disbursement via IFPE
Payment-to-rights	None	Token-based	None	Configurable per community
Multi-vertical	Single vertical	Crypto-native only	Government only	Any organized community
Accessibility	Admin-focused	Technical barrier	Web-only	Mobile-first, universal

Table 10. Civitas is the only system where decisions have automatic financial consequences across any community type.

12. Risk Analysis

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
IFPE partner failure	High	Fund segregation. Migration path to alternative IFPE. Import mode as fallback.
Community misuses auto-execution	Medium	Configurable cool-down periods. Thresholds. Manual override option.
Regulatory changes	Medium	Established IFPE partner. Swappable financial layer architecture.
Governance capture (majority abuse)	Medium	Qualified majorities for rule changes. Configurable minority protections.
Slow adoption of payment-to-vote	Low	Feature is optional per community. Platform works without it.
Competition from incumbents	Medium	Integrated primitive system is architectural moat. Hard to replicate.

Table 11. Key risks and structural mitigations.

13. Technical Roadmap

Phase	Duration	Deliverable
1. Core MVP	6–8 weeks	1 condo: Identity + Treasury (import) + Governance. Manual execution.
2. Pilot	2–4 weeks	10 real users. Validate transparency + governance PMF.
3. Financial Rail	6–8 weeks	IFPE integration. CLABEs, webhooks, auto-reconciliation.
4. Integrated Primitives	4–6 weeks	Payment-to-vote link. Executable governance. Rules Engine.
5. Multi-vertical	3–4 weeks	Configuration engine. Second vertical with different parameters.
6. Federation + Census	6–8 weeks	2+ connected communities. Verified economic metrics.
7. Scale	Ongoing	Financial products. Multi-IFPE. On-chain audit trail.

Table 12. Phase 4 (Integrated Primitives) is the core differentiator activation.

> *Critical rule: No phase advances until the current phase has real users providing feedback.*

14. Security and Privacy

14.1 Security Architecture

- **Identity:** Supabase Auth with future migration path to portable cryptographic identity.
- **Treasury:** Row-Level Security per community. All financial data isolated at the database level.
- **Governance:** Votes are immutable once cast. Full audit trail for every action.
- **Financial Rail:** TLS for all IFPE communications. Webhook signature verification. Fund segregation by law. Civitas never stores bank credentials.
- **Execution safety:** Configurable cool-down periods between vote and disbursement. Minimum balance checks. Admin override with audit trail for edge cases.
- **Multi-tenancy:** PostgreSQL RLS on every table. Community-level rule isolation.

14.2 Privacy Model

Within a community: Financial transparency is structural. All transactions visible to all members. Payment status is visible because it affects governance rights — this is configurable per community.

Between communities: Privacy is the default. RLS guarantees complete data isolation.

Financial privacy: Data through the IFPE is subject to Mexican banking secrecy laws. Individual bank-of-origin details are visible only to the payer and admin. The IFPE handles all regulatory reporting.

15. Conclusion

We have proposed a system where collective decisions have automatic financial consequences, financial standing determines governance rights, and identity status reflects both. This is not three separate tools bolted together — it is a single integrated machine for community self-governance.

In v1, we identified three primitives. In v2, we expanded to five and added data ingestion. In v3, we connected everything: a fintech partner provides the financial rail, executable governance closes the gap between decision and action, and a configurable rules engine lets each community define how the pieces interact.

The result is a system where any community — a condominium, an NGO, a cooperative, a sports club, a labor union, a neighborhood association — can say: 'We voted to hire this company, and the money was transferred automatically. We can all see it. Nobody had to trust the board to do it.'

That sentence is impossible with any existing tool. Civitas makes it routine.

The five primitives are universal. The engine is configurable. The verticals are plugins — each one just a different parameter set on the same machine. The financial rail handles real money. The rules engine handles real enforcement. And the federation turns isolated communities into a network of self-governing entities that can prove what they are. Anywhere members contribute resources and a smaller group administers them, Civitas gives the real owners back their voice.

> *Civitas is not a network state. Civitas is infrastructure that makes network states possible.*

References

[1] Srinivasan, B. (2022). *The Network State: How to Start a New Country*.
[2] Ley para Regular las Instituciones de Tecnología Financiera (2018). DOF México.